MODULE 29 · DOMAIN 2 - PROCESS

Evaluating status: metrics, charts and artefacts

Choosing metrics, reading burndown, burnup and cumulative flow charts, and tailoring, maintaining and making artefacts accessible.

DOMAIN II - Process EXAM WEIGHT 41% MODULE 29 of 49

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Status is not what people say. It is what the evidence shows.

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Kinds of metric

KIND	EXAMPLES
Schedule and cost	SPI, CPI, milestones, burn rate
Flow	Throughput, cycle time, lead time, work in progress
Quality	Defects found, escaped defects, test pass rate
Value	Features used, benefits realised, adoption
Stakeholder	Satisfaction scores, engagement, feedback
Team	Happiness, turnover, sustainable pace

ON THE EXAM

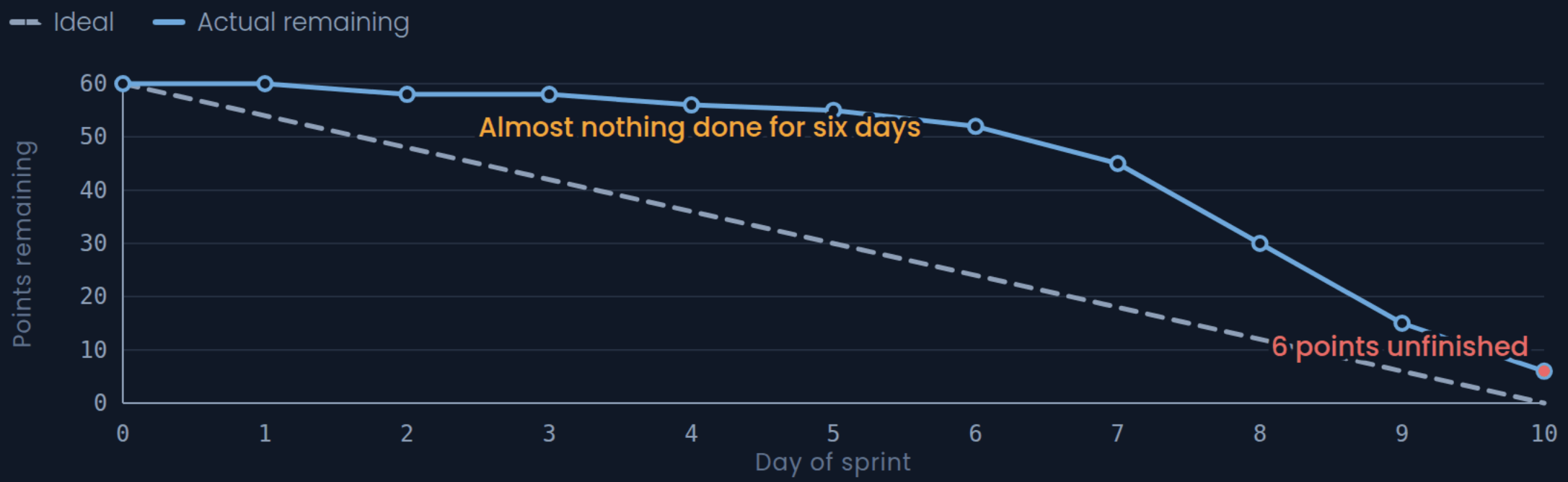
Measure a balanced set. Speed alone, without quality or value, rewards the wrong behaviour.

Metrics that help, and metrics that harm

- Few, relevant, **actionable**: each one should prompt a decision when it moves.
- Agreed **thresholds**, so everyone knows when a number matters.
- **Vanity metrics** look good and change nothing: lines of code, hours logged.
- **Goodhart's law**: when a measure becomes a target, it stops being a good measure.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Reward outcomes, not the measure. Targets on velocity or points produce inflated points, not faster delivery.

A sprint burndown



ON THE EXAM

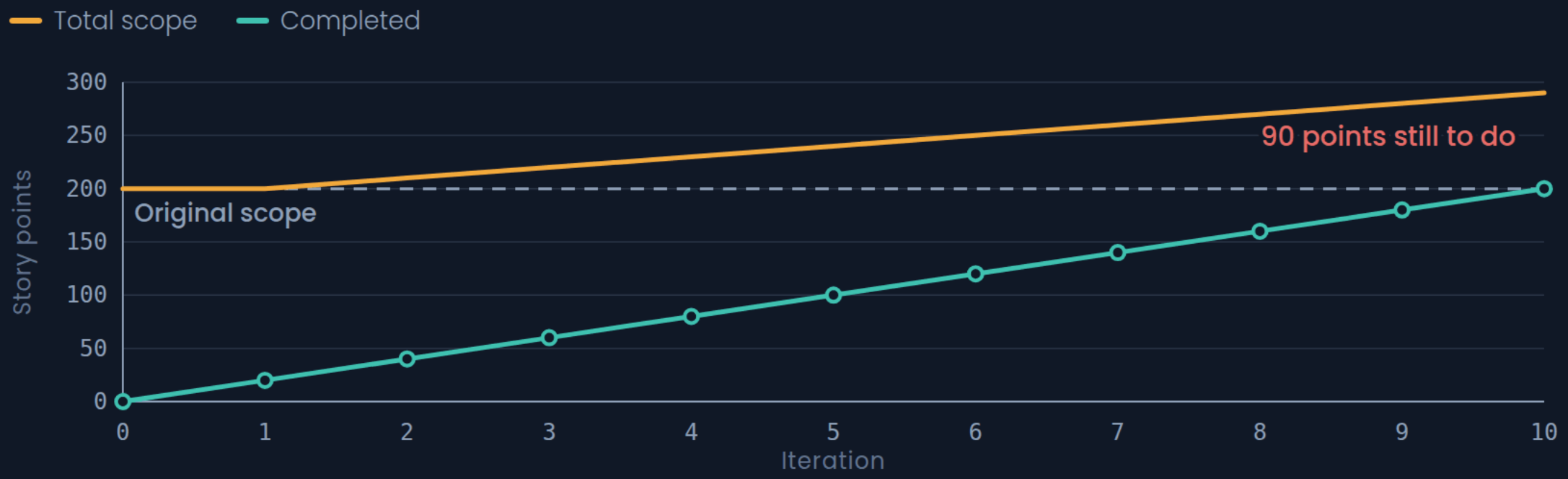
Above the ideal line: behind. Flat for days: nothing reaching done. A late cliff: stories too big.

Reading a burndown

- **Above** the ideal line: behind. **Below** it: ahead.
- **Flat** for several days: nothing is reaching done, perhaps blocked or too large.
- A sudden **rise**: work was added during the sprint.
- A burndown mixes progress and scope change. A rise could be either new work or re-estimation.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Burndowns show remaining work. When scope changes, they cannot tell you why the line moved.

A release burnup



ON THE EXAM

Two lines: scope and done. If scope had not grown, this release would be finished now.

Burndown or burnup?

BURNDOWN

Work remaining

- One line going down
- Simple and familiar
- Scope changes are hidden in the line
- Common for a single sprint

BURNUP

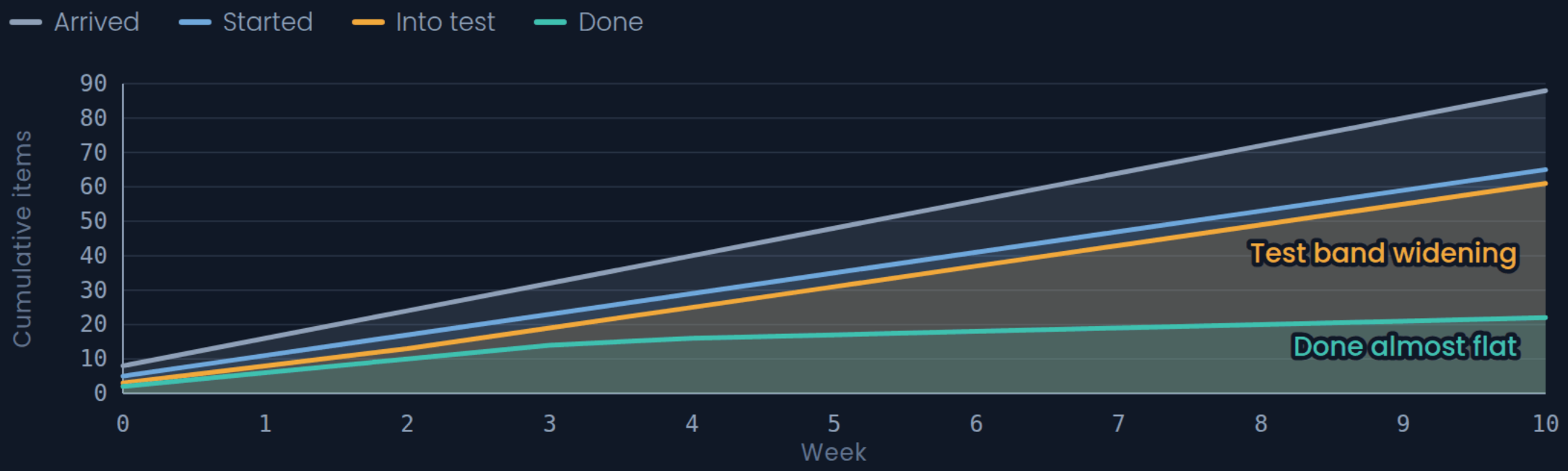
Work done, and total scope

- Two lines going up
- Shows progress and scope separately
- Reveals scope growth clearly
- Common for releases and projects

THE TIEBREAKER

Scope changing and people asking why the date slips? A burnup shows it. A burndown hides it.

A cumulative flow diagram



ON THE EXAM

Band width is work in that state. A widening band is a bottleneck. A flattening 'Done' line means little is finishing.

Reading a cumulative flow diagram

- **Vertical** thickness of a band: how much work is in that stage.
- **Horizontal** distance across the bands: roughly how long items take, the lead time.
- A **widening** band: a bottleneck in that stage, or the stage after it.
- A **flat** top line: no new work arriving. A flat done line: nothing finishing.
- Parallel, steady bands mean smooth flow.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Look for the band that widens. Then fix flow there, usually by limiting work in progress upstream.

Other status charts, in brief

CHART	SHOWS
Earned value S-curve	Cost and schedule performance together (module 27)
Control chart	Whether a process is stable (module 28)
Velocity chart	Points completed per iteration, and its stability
Cycle time scatter	How long each item took, and the spread
Milestone chart and RAG status	Key dates, and status against thresholds (module 15)

ON THE EXAM

Choose the chart that answers the question being asked. Every chart hides something.

Project artefacts

KIND	EXAMPLES
Strategy	Business case, charter, vision, roadmap
Plans and baselines	Integrated plan, schedule, budget, scope baseline
Logs and registers	Risk, issue, assumption, change, decision, lessons learned, stakeholder
Backlogs and boards	Product backlog, iteration backlog, task board
Visual data	Burnup, burndown, cumulative flow, dashboards
Reports and agreements	Status reports, contracts, team charter

ON THE EXAM

An artefact exists to be used. If nobody uses it, question whether you need it.

Tailoring and maintaining artefacts

- The outline asks you to **identify and tailor** the artefacts the project needs.
- Keep the ones that add value or that governance and regulation require. Lighten the rest.
- Use **version control** and one source of truth, so everyone works from the current version.
- Review and update on a rhythm. An out-of-date register is worse than none: it misleads.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Tailor the set of artefacts to the project, keep what governance requires, and keep what you keep current.

Accessible artefacts

- New in 2026: the outline asks you to **ensure accessibility of artefacts**.
- **Findable**: people know where they are, and have the right permissions.
- **Readable by everyone**: screen-reader friendly formats, plain language, clear structure.
- **Colour is never the only signal**: label red, amber and green, or use shapes and patterns.
- **Available across time zones**, and in formats that work on the tools people actually have.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> An artefact some team members cannot open, read or interpret is not transparent. Fix access and format.

Analysis and reconciliation

- The outline's first status enabler: **metrics, analysis and reconciliation**.
- When two sources disagree, such as a green burnup and a red earned value, find out why before reporting.
- Check definitions: are both measuring the same scope, with the same 'done'?
- Then **assess the effectiveness** of artefact management: are artefacts used, current and trusted?

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Reconcile conflicting numbers before you report them. Two versions of the truth destroy trust.

Project Lantern: reading the evidence

- The app's **release burnup** showed scope creeping up; the product owner cut two features to hold the date.
- The support team's **cumulative flow** showed faults piling up at supplier review; a daily call cleared it.
- The steering dashboard labels every status with a word as well as a colour.
- The PMO's 40-document template was tailored to 12, agreed with the PMO.

ON THE EXAM

Charts that led to decisions, artefacts everyone can read, and a tailored set agreed with governance.

Scenario signals and the move

THE CHART OR SCENARIO SHOWS	THE MOVE
Burndown flat, then a late cliff	Stories too big or unfinished; split them, finish before starting
Burnup: done steady, scope line rising	Scope growth: manage scope against the date
Cumulative flow: one band widening	Bottleneck: limit WIP upstream, help that stage
Someone cannot read or reach an artefact	Fix accessibility: labels, formats, permissions
A metric became a target and got gamed	Goodhart's law: measure outcomes instead
Documents nobody reads, heavy template	Tailor artefacts, with governance's agreement

ON THE EXAM

Read the shape of the chart, name what it reveals, and act on the cause.

> A team's sprint burndown stays almost flat for the first six days of a ten-day sprint, then drops steeply in the last three days. Several points are still unfinished at the end.
>
> This pattern has repeated for three sprints.

What does the pattern most likely indicate?

A The team is ahead of schedule and finishing early.

B Stories are too large, or work is started but not finished until late.

C The product owner removed scope during each sprint.

D The team's velocity is steadily increasing.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What does the pattern most likely indicate?

A Ahead of schedule.

Flat above the ideal line means behind, and work is left over.

B Stories too large, or finished late.

Nothing reaches done until the end: a classic burndown shape.

C Scope removed.

Removing scope causes a sudden drop at that moment, not a flat line first.

D Velocity rising.

Unfinished work every sprint says the opposite.

THE SIGNAL

Flat, then a cliff, with leftovers: stories too big, or too much started and too little finished.

A release burnup shows the team completing about twenty points every iteration, steadily. The total scope line has risen in every iteration since the start.

The sponsor asks why the release date keeps slipping, and whether the team is underperforming.

What should the project manager do?

A Tell the sponsor the team is slowing down, and ask it to work faster.

B Add developers to the team to increase velocity.

C Replace the burnup with a burndown to simplify the picture.

D Show that growing scope is the cause, and work with the product owner and sponsor on scope versus date.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A The team is slowing.

The completed line is steady. Blaming the team misreads the chart.

B Add developers.

Treats a scope problem as a capacity problem.

C Switch to a burndown.

Hides the very scope growth that explains the slip.

D Show scope growth; decide scope versus date.

Reads the chart correctly and puts the trade-off with the decision-makers.

THE SIGNAL

Burnup with steady progress and rising scope: it is a scope decision, not a performance problem.

> A Kanban team's cumulative flow diagram shows the 'In test' band widening steadily for five weeks. The 'Done' line has almost flattened. The 'In progress' band is thin and steady.
>
> The team lead proposes adding two more developers.

What should the project manager do?

A Treat testing as the bottleneck: limit work entering test, and have the team help clear it.

B Add the two developers, as proposed.

C Take no action, since development is flowing smoothly.

D Pull more items into progress to keep developers busy.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Testing bottleneck: limit WIP, help clear it.

The widening band locates the constraint; flow improves only there.

B Add developers.

More development feeds a queue that is already stuck at test.

C No action.

Almost nothing is finishing. Smooth development is not the goal; done is.

D Start more work.

Increases work in progress, and lengthens every item's lead time.

THE SIGNAL

A widening band marks the bottleneck. Improve flow there; more work upstream only deepens the queue.

> A team member with red-green colour vision deficiency cannot interpret the project's red, amber and green status dashboard.
>
> Meanwhile, two remote contractors cannot open the risk register at all, because of file permissions.

What should the project manager do?

A. Ask colleagues to explain the dashboard to the team member each week.

B. Print the dashboard and register for everyone.

C. Make the artefacts accessible: add text labels or symbols to status, and fix the contractors' access.

D. Remove the colour coding and stop sharing the risk register.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Have colleagues explain it.

A workaround that makes one person dependent, and fixes nothing.

B Print everything.

Out of date quickly, and useless for remote contractors.

C Labels or symbols; fix access.

Ensures accessibility of artefacts, the new 2026 enabler.

D Remove colour; stop sharing.

Throws away useful information and reduces transparency.

THE SIGNAL

Colour must never be the only signal, and artefacts must be reachable by those who need them.

> Management began ranking agile teams by story points completed per sprint, with a bonus for the top team. Within three sprints, every team's velocity has risen sharply.
>
> Customers report no improvement in what is actually delivered.

What should the project manager recommend?

A. Keep the ranking, since velocity has improved.

B. Replace the ranking with measures of outcomes and value, and explain why points became unreliable.

C. Cap the number of points each team may claim per sprint.

D. Standardise story points across teams so the ranking is fair.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager recommend?

A Keep the ranking.

The velocity rise is inflation, not delivery. Customers see no change.

B Measure outcomes; explain the problem.

Goodhart's law in action. Reward what customers actually value.

C Cap the points.

Treats the symptom; teams will game the next rule.

D Standardise points.

Keeps a target on a measure that should never be a target.

THE SIGNAL

When a measure becomes a target, it stops measuring. Velocity rose; delivery did not.

> A small eight-week internal project must use the PMO's standard template, which requires twenty-five documents. The team spends nearly a third of its time on them.
>
> Stakeholders say they read only the status summary and the risk register.

What should the project manager do?

A. Produce all twenty-five documents, since the template is mandatory.

B. Stop producing the documents, since nobody reads them.

C. Outsource the documentation to an administrator.

D. Work with the PMO to tailor the artefacts to those that add value, keeping what governance requires.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Produce all 25.

A third of an 8-week project spent on documents nobody reads.

B Stop them all.

Breaks a governance requirement unilaterally.

C Outsource them.

Still produces unused documents, now at extra cost.

D Tailor with the PMO.

Identify and tailor artefacts, with governance's agreement.

THE SIGNAL

Heavy artefacts nobody uses: tailor them with governance. Neither obey blindly nor ignore the rule.

Read the shape. Name what it reveals. Act on the cause.

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